

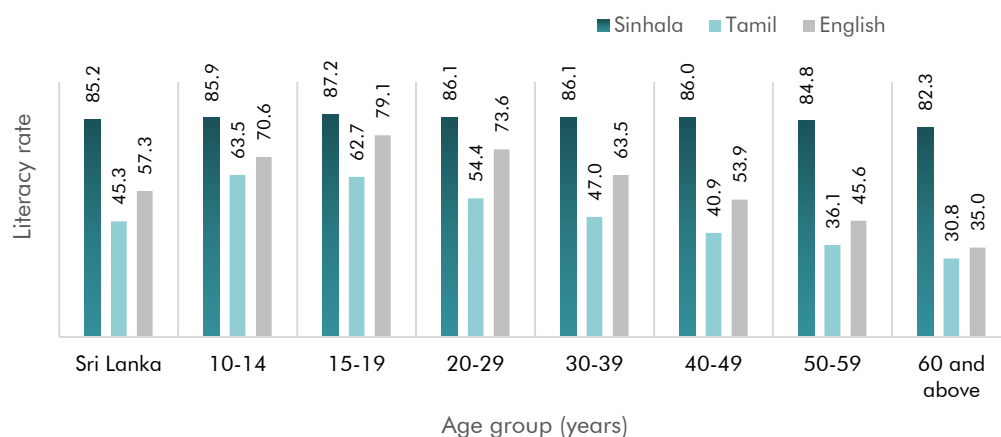


Figure 7.3 : Language Literacy Rate by Age Group and Language, 2024

As illustrated in Figure 7.3, literacy rates in Tamil and English decline steadily with increasing age. Among individuals aged 60 and above, Tamil literacy drops to 30.8% and English literacy to 35.0%, reflecting more limited educational opportunities and language exposure in the past.

Language Literacy by District Level

Table 7.10 : Language Literacy Rate by Language and District, 2024

District	Population Aged 10 & over	Literacy Rate (%)			
		At least one Language	Sinhala	Tamil	English
Sri Lanka	19,010,157	97.4	85.2	45.3	57.3
Colombo	2,139,371	98.6	94.1	41.5	74.2
Gampaha	2,169,227	98.9	97.1	32.9	67.2
Kalutara	1,151,651	98.5	96.0	36.6	62.5
Kandy	1,275,003	97.5	90.9	50.1	64.8
Matale	456,498	96.7	91.4	42.4	54.8
Nuwara Eliya	623,842	93.6	59.5	68.0	47.1
Galle	962,957	97.8	97.0	29.8	59.4
Matara	732,282	97.1	96.1	28.1	55.3
Hambantota	577,879	97.2	96.8	28.8	52.0
Jaffna	520,973	98.3	17.1	97.9	41.0
Mannar	104,513	98.4	16.7	97.9	33.2
Vavuniya	148,116	97.3	31.0	90.6	43.4
Mullaitivu	105,684	97.3	19.6	90.9	31.7
Kilinochchi	117,894	97.5	13.3	96.7	33.7
Batticaloa	500,111	92.7	23.0	91.9	41.6
Ampara	620,964	95.6	58.3	71.9	50.8
Trincomalee	367,577	95.5	44.3	77.7	42.3
Kurunegala	1,544,135	98.1	96.7	35.2	55.8
Puttalam	702,941	97.3	85.7	43.2	50.6
Anuradhapura	826,680	97.7	95.2	38.0	52.2
Polonnaruwa	384,562	97.2	92.9	34.7	46.9
Badulla	757,145	95.8	87.2	51.2	53.5
Moneragala	450,128	96.8	95.4	36.3	49.7
Rathnapura	1,003,077	97.0	93.8	36.3	50.9
Kegalle	766,947	98.1	94.8	41.1	58.2